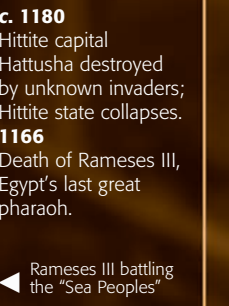
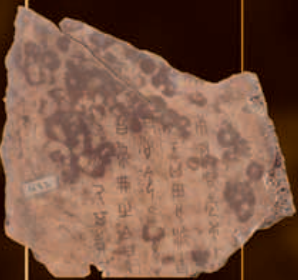


1500 BCE		1400 BCE		1300 BCE		1200 BCE	
	Mid-1400s Lapita people move beyond Melanesia to begin colonizing rest of Pacific. Mycenaean Greece at summit of power, with trading links from the Levant to Sicily. ◀ Mycenaean-style Minoan vase, Crete	Kassite Babylonian "boundary stone" ▶ c. 1400 Anyang becomes capital of Shang Dynasty China in place of Zhengzhou; first Chinese inscriptions on oracle bones. Nomadic cattle herding develops on the steppes. 		1200s Middle Assyrian period: kings such as Tiglath-Pileser I build an Assyrian empire in northern Mesopotamia, Syria, and Anatolia. Cult of Osiris, involving the "Book of the Dead," popular in Egypt.		c. 1200 Urnfield Culture emerges in Danube area of Europe. Olmec civilization develops in Mexico. Chavín civilization emerges in coastal Peru. Jewish exodus from Egypt to found kingdoms in the Levant. Ugarit letter ▶ 	
		◀ Pharaoh Akhenaten c. 1350 Amarna Period of Egypt; Amenophis IV styles himself "Akhenaten," founds short-lived capital El-Amarna, advocates worship of Aten, the Sun, and instigates an artistic revolution.			c. 1250 Stronger defenses around Mycenaean palaces indicate increasing threats. 1213 Death of Rameses II.		
c. 1500 Hittite Old Kingdom of Anatolia declines; kingdom of Mittani emerges nearby in north Mesopotamia. c. 1500–900 Vedic-period Aryans expand over north India; hymns of Rig Veda composed.	▲ Mycenaean gold Late 1400s Warfare between New Kingdom Egypt, Hittite New Kingdom, and Mittani for control of the Levant. 1417 Egypt's New Kingdom reaches peak under Amenophis III.			c. 1275 Egyptians under Rameses II fight the Hittites at the Battle of Kadesh. ▼ Egyptian "Book of the Dead"			c. 1180 Hittite capital Hattusha destroyed by unknown invaders; Hittite state collapses. 1166 Death of Rameses III, Egypt's last great pharaoh.
		1300s First alphabets evident on Sinai peninsula (now in Egypt) and in city of Ugarit in the Levant. Kassite Babylonia, the Hittites, Mittani, and Egypt linked diplomatically and by intermarriage. ▼ Shang-Chinese oracle bone	Mid-1300s City of Ashur breaks free from Mittani; its rulers proclaim themselves kings of Assyria. c. 1336 Priests of Amun restore religious and artistic orthodoxy in Egypt during young Tutankhamun's reign.				1154 Kassite dynasty of Babylon ended when city is sacked by neighboring Elam. c. 1150 Mycenaean Greece collapses; start of Greek dark ages. ▼ Philistine mask
▲ Hatshepsut's temple, New Kingdom Egypt Early 1400s Bronzeworking in Thailand and Vietnam. Copper worked in Sahara. Evidence of first metalworking in Peru. First pottery in Central America.			c. 1258 Hittite king Hattusili III agrees Treaty of Kadesh with Rameses II of Egypt.		1100s Mycenaean cities destroyed. Ugarit letters give account of maritime raids on the Levant coast. Egypt battles with the "Sea Peoples"—some linked with the Philistines. Chariots spread to China from Central Asia.		